Findings Barcelona WFC

Clustering results

For all of k = 2, k = 3, and k = 4, Barcelona's clustering outcome was almost equal for all clusters. In the end, they ended up with front-footed teams in k = 2, wide crossers in k = 3, and central combiners in k = 4.

Like patient teams

Barcelona was not progressive when it comes to passing, and their build up was less direct and more patient. More of their shots were from open play and less were from direct set piece and transitions. Less box entries were done via passing. Left channel was their main channel of attack.

Like front-footed teams

Barcelona was particularly aggresive in average defensive location; in fact, their average defensive location was in the opposition half. They were also active with counterpress actions. On the other hand, they did not progressively carry the ball much.

Like wide crossers

They attempted more crosses, with fewer of their final third actions happening down the middle.

Like central combiners

They had slightly more carries into the final third centrally, and attempted much more through balls.

Pitch profile

Only a fifth of Barcelona's attack went down the middle, while the left flank was significantly more used than the right flank.

Formations and typical XI

4-3-3 was the most used formation by Barcelona by a significant margin. Most position saw significant rotations throughout the season, apart from Bonmati as right center midfield, Graham Hansen as right winger, Batlle at left back.

Similar teams

Being the most dominant team, Barcelona somehow ended up with a squad similarly built to Bristol City, the least dominant team. However, there are more teams that played like Barcelona than built like Barcelona.

The full Barcelona team report (PDF).